

Cracked!

Player-facing; no Ref defense roll, no leftover math.

AC sets a minimum — it does not reduce damage. After Defend, the blow either bounces off or sinks in full.

Remaining Damage vs AC	Result
$\leq$ Harden	<i>Tink!</i> — no damage
$>$ Harden	Full damage (nothing subtracted)

Always express armor and natural protection in the same human terms:

Kit	AC	<i>Tink</i>	Hurts
Unarmored / soft	0	—	any
Leather	1	1	2+
Gambeson	2	1–2	3+
Chain	3	1–3	4+
Plate	4	1–4	5+
Full plate / harder	5+	1–5+	6+

Fiction is kit when it wears kit: *that orc is in gambeson, mail, plate*. Natural hide/shell uses the same words: skeleton **as leather**, crab **as plate**, dragon **as full plate** or harder. Players may ask.

Poleax Spark: break armor instead of taking the extra action. Resolve that blow at AC 0; that armor gives no AC for the rest of the fight.

0 HP → Cracked! Still fights. AC and Resistance are gone; the next hit drops them — even a 1 finishes.

Named Resistance (silver, fire...) uses the same binary rule. AC and Resistance never add; use the highest applicable threshold.